

8. Create an application that keeps track of how many times a visitor has loaded the page.

✔ Method 1: Using PHP Session (Per Visitor Count)

□ Explanation:

- `session_start()` → Starts a session
- `$_SESSION` → Stores user-specific data
- Each time the page loads, the counter increases by 1

□ PHP Code:

```
<?php
// Start the session (creates a new session or resumes existing one)
session_start();

// Check whether the session variable 'count' is already created
if(isset($_SESSION['count']))
{
    // If it exists, increase the count value by 1
    $_SESSION['count'] = $_SESSION['count'] + 1;
}
else
{
    // If it does not exist (first visit), initialize count to 1
    $_SESSION['count'] = 1;
}

// Display the number of times the page is visited
echo "<h2>You have visited this page " . $_SESSION['count'] . " times.</h2>";
?>
```

✔ Method 2: Using Cookies (Alternative Method)

□ PHP Code:

```
<?php
// Check whether the cookie named 'visit' already exists
if(isset($_COOKIE['visit']))
```

```

{
    // If cookie exists, increase its value by 1
    $count = $_COOKIE['visit'] + 1;
}
else
{
    // If cookie does not exist (first visit), initialize count to 1
    $count = 1;
}

// Create/Update the cookie
// 'visit' is cookie name
// $count is value stored in cookie
// time()+3600 means cookie will expire after 1 hour (3600 seconds)

setcookie('visit', $count, time()+3600);

// Display the number of times the page is visited
echo "<h2>You have visited this page $count times.</h2>";
?>

```

☐ Difference Between Session and Cookie

Session	Cookie
Stored on server	Stored on user browser
More secure	Less secure
Deleted when browser closes	Can set expiry time
